

Brendan Keaton

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity Architect

CFA Institute

Charlottesville, VA

Apr 2026 – Present

- Designed and co-authored a company-wide security knowledge hub serving as the central platform for security announcements, organizational structure, points of contact, and ongoing security education content.
- Led the evaluation, planning, and deployment of BumbleBee, an open-source endpoint scanner for detecting compromised software packages across major package ecosystems, including npm, pnpm, PyPi and Yarn.
- Contributed to the architecture and implementation of a secure Software Development Lifecycle (SDLC), integrating application security tooling, dependency scanning, and secrets management best practices.

Cyber Security Engineer II (Identity Access Management)

CarMax

Richmond, VA

Jun 2025 – Apr 2026

- Developed custom SCIM connectors integrating SailPoint IdentityNow with third-party platforms, enabling automated provisioning and bidirectional identity data exchange across internal applications.
- Led architectural planning of the internal IAM application, including a new front-end experience, enhanced security posture, expanded functionality, and deep SailPoint integration.
- Implemented 15+ enterprise SSO integrations using SAML and OpenID Connect (OAuth 2.0) via PingFederate, improving authentication security and end-user experience.

Software Development Contractor

Scope Labs, Resonite, Tribunus Health

Remote

Oct 2023 – May 2025

- Built a Golang-based API layer supporting shipping logistics and dispatch workflows at scale.
- Delivered 10+ client projects across distinct stacks including Firebase/Flask/React and PostgreSQL/FastAPI/Next.js
- Led implementation of a sponsored posts and SEO initiative on an established web application, driving increased platform revenue and organic user growth.
- Served as the sole developer for a B2B analytics dashboard, delivering insights across 30+ business metrics, including time-series analysis to support decision-making for the client.

Data Analyst Intern

AstraZeneca Pharmaceuticals

Wilmington, DE

Jun 2023 – Sep 2023

- Built Python/Pandas automation pipelines and Power BI dashboards, eliminating 200+ annual hours of manual reporting and supporting 30+ business users.

Data Analyst Intern

Virginia State Board of Elections

Richmond, VA

Jun 2022 – Sep 2022

- Automated reporting workflows using SQL and Excel VBA, reducing manual reporting effort by approximately 2 hours per day, while collaborating with 50+ localities to resolve GIS population-data discrepancies.

EDUCATION

University of Virginia

BS in Computer Science; Minor in Data Science

Charlottesville, VA

Cumulative GPA: 3.6/4.0;

PROJECTS

Annex (OSS Cybersecurity Project)

March 2026 - Current

- Created and open-sourced Annex, a cross-platform desktop application (Windows, macOS, Linux) that protects sensitive files during AI-assisted workflows by temporarily encrypting and restricting access to credentials, PII, source code, and other confidential data.
- Developed the application in Rust and Tauri, implementing AES-256-GCM file encryption, secure file deletion, editor artifact detection and cleanup, memory zeroization, and crash-recovery mechanisms.

- Published a technical analysis detailing the threat model, security assumptions, and architectural design behind Annex's approach to protecting sensitive data from local AI assistants (<https://blog.brendankeaton.com/self-service-ransomware-as-security-against-local-ai-tools>).

MBX Technologies

May 2025 - Current

- Co-founded a software consulting firm, generating \$50K+ in revenue and 5 client engagements within the first 6 months, delivering full-stack and backend systems for fintech startups and healthcare practices.
- Led system architecture and technical delivery across client projects, spanning Next.js, FastAPI, Supabase, PostgreSQL, and cloud deployment, with a focus on security, scalability, and performance.

Statistex

October 2024 - February 2025

- Developed an analytics dashboard SAAS with the goal of improving performance and consistency in players. Project built using FastAPI/Nextjs/Postgresql.
- Designed a Valkey-based fingerprinting algorithm (open-source Redis) to deduplicate events prior to persistence, removing database-level uniqueness constraints and improving p99 write latency. (Blog post here: <https://blog.brendankeaton.com/idempotent-event-ingestion-multi-producer>)
- Demo video for frontend of MVP: (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?app=desktop&v=RuPoUb40RyA>)

State of the Art in Recommendation Systems

Jan 2023 - December 2023

- Researched and synthesized machine learning methods for social media recommendation systems for my senior thesis at the University of Virginia. (<https://doi.org/10.18130/bem4-3v72>)

Languages: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Rust, Go, SQL, PowerShell, R

Frameworks: React, Next.js, FastAPI, Flask, SolidJS, Tauri, TailwindCSS, Astro

Infrastructure: PostgreSQL, Valkey/Redis, Firebase, Supabase, Docker, Azure, Vercel, AWS, Railway

Identity & Security: SailPoint, PingFederate, SAML, OAuth 2.0, SCIM, EntraID

Tools: Figma, Power BI, Pandas, Snyk, Github Actions, Cloudflare